

CS 109ACE Syllabus

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Welcome to CS 109ACE! This is a place to practice CS 109 concepts, ask questions, and learn with a small group of classmates. ACE should support your work in CS 109, not add another set of assignments or exams to your week. We'll adjust our meetings based on what you find useful, so please tell me what is working and what could be better.

If you are interested in the course but have a conflict, reach out to ehersch@stanford.edu. We can make accomodations and move the course to a time that suits more students.

1 What we'll cover

We'll follow the topics in CS 109, including counting and probability, random variables and expected value, and introductory statistics and machine learning. Our material will supplement the main course and be paced accordingly to what the class prefers.

2 Meetings and support

We meet Tuesdays from 9:30–11:20 a.m. in 160-328, beginning September 29. We have 8 scheduled sections this quarter (every Tuesday from week 2-10 except for Democracy Day on November 3), and will include a makeup section in lieu of Democracy Day.

I'll also hold two hours of office hours each week and offer review sessions before the midterm and final. I'll share office-hour times and locations after collecting availability. Check Canvas and Slack for updates, notes, and supplementary materials. These meetings and resources are for students enrolled in CS 109ACE.

Office hours are a good place to revisit a concept, talk through where you're stuck, or practice a similar problem. You don't need to have a fully formed question before coming.

I will also host review sessions for both the midterm and final. Currently, they will be in-class review, but if students want separate sessions, this can be scheduled as well.

3 What a section looks like

Our 110 minutes will usually look like this:

- 15 minutes: check in, discuss course logistics, and identify questions
- 15 minutes: review recent material and revisit concepts you request
- 20 minutes: work through key ideas, derivations, proofs, or code together
- 10-minute break
- 50 minutes: solve practice problems, first with examples and then in small groups

This is a starting structure, and I will adjust it throughout the quarter based on student feedback. I may ask you to explain an approach at the board or compare solutions with a classmate. The point is to find gaps in our understanding and work through them together. Mistakes and questions are welcome.

4 Attendance and credit

ACE is graded Credit/No Credit based on attendance. I'll take attendance at every section; reporting attendance inaccurately is an Honor Code violation. To receive credit, you must attend at least seven of our nine sections and earn a C- or higher in CS 109. If you drop CS 109, you should also drop CS 109ACE.

Please contact me early if illness, a conflict, or another circumstance may affect your attendance. We can discuss your situation and any available accommodations. I'll confirm expectations for the review sessions separately.

5 Collaboration and course work

You are encouraged to discuss ideas and practice problems with classmates. Work submitted for CS 109 must remain your own and follow the main course's collaboration and AI policies. I can help you understand concepts and practice related techniques, but I won't complete graded assignments for you or work through assigned exam questions in section.

We will discuss appropriate AI use together. For graded CS 109 work, follow the policy in the main course syllabus; when in doubt, ask the course staff before using an AI tool. Any ACE practice materials will be approved by the rest of the CS 109 staff before I share them.

6 Communication and accessibility

Use our course Slack to connect with classmates and ask general questions; use Canvas for course announcements and materials. You can also reach out to me directly when a question is personal or you'd prefer not to ask it in the group. I'll offer ways to give feedback both in person and anonymously.

Join our course Slack [here](#).

If you have accommodations through the Office of Accessible Education (OAE), please reach out so we can make our meetings accessible to you. You are also welcome to speak with me about a barrier to participating, whether or not you have a formal accommodation.

I hope we can make this a supportive place to learn together. There will also be snacks!